Packet Jeopardy: How to Play

Goal: Your team earns points by answering review questions about packets, HTTP & HTML, fault tolerance, and routing. The team with the most points after the Final Round wins.

1. Set up your team

Teams have 4–6 students. Your team gets **one whiteboard and one marker**. Pick a team name, then give everyone a job:

Job	What you do	Example
Captain	Picks the tile when it's your turn. Makes the final call if your team disagrees. Decides bets.	"We're going with 'routers.' Write it."
Writer	Writes your team's answer neatly and big enough for the teacher to read.	Writes: ROUTERS
Checker	Reads the answer back before time runs out. Makes sure it answers the whole question.	"The question asked for TWO things. We only wrote one."
Everyone else	Helps think of the answer. Talk quietly so other teams can't hear.	"I think it's TCP. It resends lost packets."

2. How every turn works

Teams take turns being **in control** (Team 1, then Team 2, then Team 3…). The team in control picks the tile, but **every team answers every question.**

#	Step	What happens	Example
1	**Pick**	The Captain of the team in control says a category and a point value.	Team 2: "Packets & Fault Tolerance for 200."
2	**Read**	The teacher shows the question on the board and starts the 30-second timer.	`A ping report says 10 sent and 7 received. What happened to the other 3?`
3	**Write**	Every team talks quietly and the Writer writes one answer. You have **30 seconds**.	Team 1 writes: `They were lost in the network (packet loss)`
4	**Boards up**	When the timer says **Time!**, every team holds up its board at the same time. No more writing.	All four boards go up together.
5	**Score**	The teacher reveals the answer. **Every team** with a correct answer earns the points. Wrong answers lose nothing.	Teams 1, 2 and 4 are right: +200 each. Team 3 wrote "they were slow": +0.

After the turn, control moves to the next team. In the example, Team 3 picks the next tile. Here is what the scoreboard looks like before and after that turn:

	Team 1	Team 2	Team 3	Team 4
Before	300	500	400	100
This turn	**+200**	**+200**	+0	**+200**
After	**500**	**700**	**400**	**300**

3. What counts as a correct answer?

Your answer has to actually answer the question. Spelling doesn't need to be perfect. **Low values (100–200)** usually need a word or a short phrase. **High values (400–500)** ask you to explain, so use the word *because* or *so*.

Question	Accepted	Not accepted (and why)
What does URL stand for? (100)	✓ Uniform Resource Locator	✗ "A web address." That's what a URL *is*, not what the letters stand for.
What device acts like a traffic manager for packets? (100)	✓ Routers / a router	✗ "The internet." Too general. Name the device.
How do we know a packet was lost? (400)	✓ Packets are numbered, so the receiver sees which number is missing and asks for it again.	✗ "It just knows." or "TCP." Doesn't explain *how*.
Why is fault tolerance good for the internet? (500)	✓ The network keeps working when parts break, **because** packets get re-routed on other paths.	✗ "Because it's good." Doesn't say what fault tolerance does.

4. The Daily Double

One tile is a hidden **Daily Double**. You won't know which one until it's picked. When it shows up:

Rule	Example
Only the team in control answers. Other teams stay quiet.	Team 4 picks *HTTP & HTML for 400*. It's the Daily Double. Team 4 has 300 points.
Before seeing the question, the team bets. You can bet up to your score, or up to 500 if your score is lower than 500.	Team 4 can bet up to 500 (their score of 300 is lower than 500). The Captain bets **400**.
Right: **add** your bet. Wrong: **subtract** your bet.	Right: 300 + 400 = **700**. Wrong: 300 − 400 = **−100**.

5. The Final Round

After the board is done, every team plays the Final Round. It is one big “explain it” question.

a. Your team **secretly** decides a bet from **0 up to your score** and writes it on a slip of paper. Hand it to the teacher before the question appears. A team with 0 or fewer points bets 0.
b. The teacher shows the question. You get extra time (usually 60–90 seconds) to write a full explanation.
c. Right: add your bet. Wrong: subtract your bet. Highest score wins.

Team	Score before	Bet	Answer	Final score
Team 1	1,200	500	**Right**	1,200 + 500 = **1,700** (winner)
Team 2	1,000	1,000	**Wrong**	1,000 − 1,000 = **0**
Team 3	800	0	**Wrong**	800 − 0 = **800**
Team 4	600	600	**Right**	600 + 600 = **1,200**

Strategy tip: If you’re in the lead, bet small to stay safe. If you’re behind, you may need a big bet to catch up. Team 2 bet everything and lost it all. Team 3 bet 0 and kept every point.

6. Fair play rules

- No notes, phones, or laptops during the game.
- Whisper with your team. If another team hears your answer, that’s on you, but shouting answers on purpose costs your team 100 points.
- Boards stay down until the teacher calls **Time!** Once boards are up, no erasing or adding.
- One answer per board. If a board has two different answers, it counts as wrong.
- If your team thinks an answer should count, the Captain can calmly explain why. **The teacher’s call is final.**

Quick version: Team in control picks → everyone writes in 30 seconds → boards up on **Time!** → every correct team earns the points → control passes to the next team.